

Topic D: Fields

D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Guiding questions

Which experiments provided evidence to determine the nature of the electron?

How can the properties of fields be understood using both an algebraic approach and a visual representation?

Topic D: Fields

D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Understandings:

Students should understand:

- the direction of forces between the two types of electric charge
- Coulomb's law as given by $F = kq_1q_2/r^2$ for charged bodies treated as point charges where $k = 1/4\pi\epsilon_0$
- the conservation of electric charge
- Millikan's experiment as evidence for quantization of electric charge

Topic D: Fields

D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Understandings:

Students should understand:

- that the electric charge can be transferred between bodies using friction, electrostatic induction and by contact, including the role of grounding (earthing)
- the electric field strength as given by $E = F/q$
- electric field lines
- the relationship between field line density and field strength
- the uniform electric field strength between parallel plates as given by $E = V/d$

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Data booklet reference:

$$F = k \frac{q_1 q_2}{r^2} \text{ where } k = \frac{1}{4\pi\epsilon_0}$$

$$E = \frac{F}{q}$$

$$E = \frac{V}{d}$$

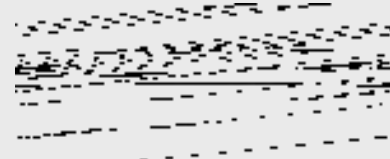
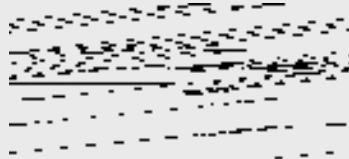
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Coulomb's law

· Charles-Augustin de Coulomb studied charge, and discovered the following relationship (now called “Coulomb’s Law”):

- The magnitude of the **electrostatic force** of interaction between two point charges is directly proportional to the scalar **multiplication of the magnitudes of charges** and inversely proportional to the **square of the distance** between them.



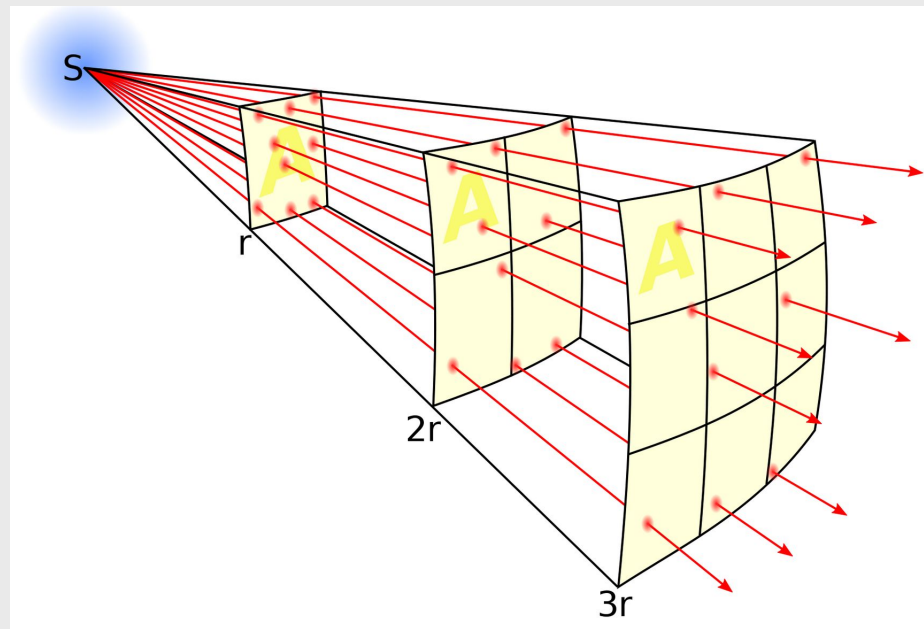
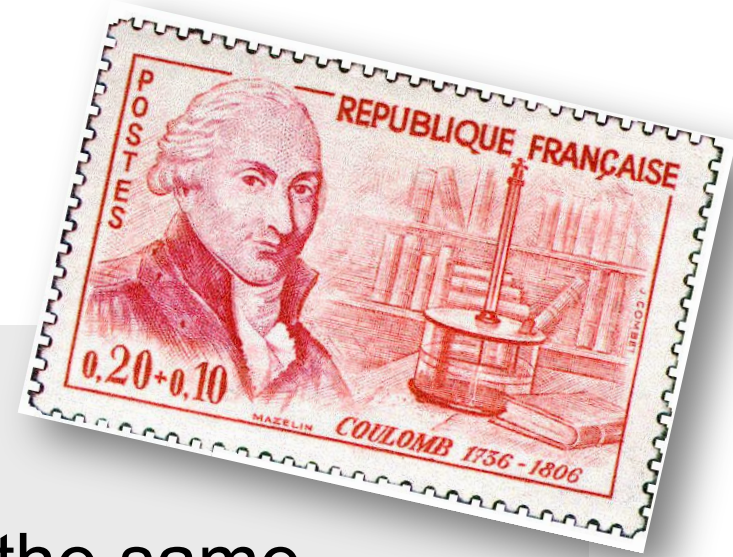
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Coulomb's law

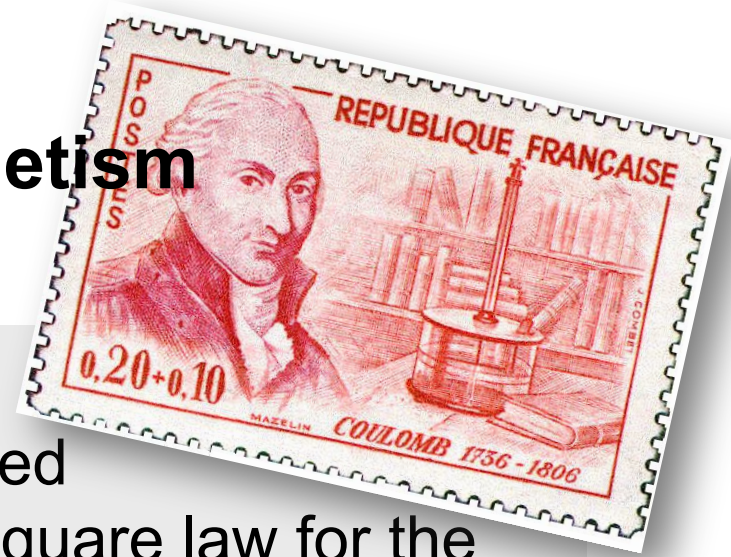
·The inverse square law:

- As distance increases, the same amount of energy is “spread out” over a larger (surface) area



Topic 5: Electricity and magnetism

5.1 – Electric fields



Coulomb's law

· Charles-Augustin de Coulomb studied charge, and discovered an inverse square law for the electric force F between two point charges q_1 and q_2 separated by distance r :

$$F = kq_1q_2 / r^2$$

where $k = 8.99 \times 10^9 \text{ N m}^2 \text{ C}^{-2}$

Coulomb's
law

· k is called Coulomb's constant. Beware. There is another constant that is designated k called Boltzmann's constant used in thermodynamics.

· There is an alternate form of Coulomb's law:

$$F = (1/[4\pi\epsilon_0])q_1q_2 / r^2$$

where $\epsilon_0 = 8.85 \times 10^{-12} \text{ C}^2 \text{ N}^{-1} \text{ m}^{-2}$

Coulomb's
law

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Coulomb's law

PRACTICE: Show that the numeric value of $1/[4\pi\epsilon_0]$ equals the numeric value of k .

SOLUTION:

- We know that $k = 8.99 \times 10^9$.
- We know that $\epsilon_0 = 8.85 \times 10^{-12}$.
- Then $1/[4\pi\epsilon_0] = 1 / [4\pi \times 8.85 \times 10^{-12}] = 8.99 \times 10^9 = k$.

FYI

- Either $F = kq_1q_2 / r^2$ or $F = (1/[4\pi\epsilon_0])q_1q_2 / r^2$ can be used. It is your choice. The first is easiest, though.
- In Topic D.1, we discovered that the gravitational force is also an **inverse square law**.

Topic D: Fields

D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Coulomb's law

PRACTICE:

Find the Coulomb force between two electrons located 1.0 cm apart.

SOLUTION:

·Note $r = 1.0 \text{ cm} = 0.010 \text{ m}$.

·Note $q_1 = e = 1.60 \times 10^{-19} \text{ C}$.

·Note $q_2 = e = 1.60 \times 10^{-19} \text{ C}$.

·From $F = kq_1q_2 / r^2$

$$\begin{aligned} F &= 8.99 \times 10^9 \times (1.60 \times 10^{-19})^2 / 0.010^2 \\ &= 2.30 \times 10^{-24} \text{ N.} \end{aligned}$$

·Since like charges repel the electrons repel.

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Coulomb's law - permittivity

PRACTICE: The ϵ_0 in Coulomb's law $F = (1/[4\pi\epsilon_0])q_1q_2/r^2$ is called the **permittivity of free space**. In general, different materials have different permittivities ϵ , and Coulomb's law has a more general form: $F = (1/[4\pi\epsilon])q_1q_2/r^2$. If the two electrons are embedded in a chunk of quartz, having a permittivity of $12\epsilon_0$, what will the Coulomb force be between them if they are 1.0 cm apart?

SOLUTION:

$$\begin{aligned} F &= (1/[4\pi\epsilon])q_1q_2/r^2 \\ &= (1/[4\pi \times 12 \times 8.85 \times 10^{-12}]) (1.60 \times 10^{-19})^2 / 0.010^2 \\ &= 1.92 \times 10^{-25} \text{ N.} \end{aligned}$$

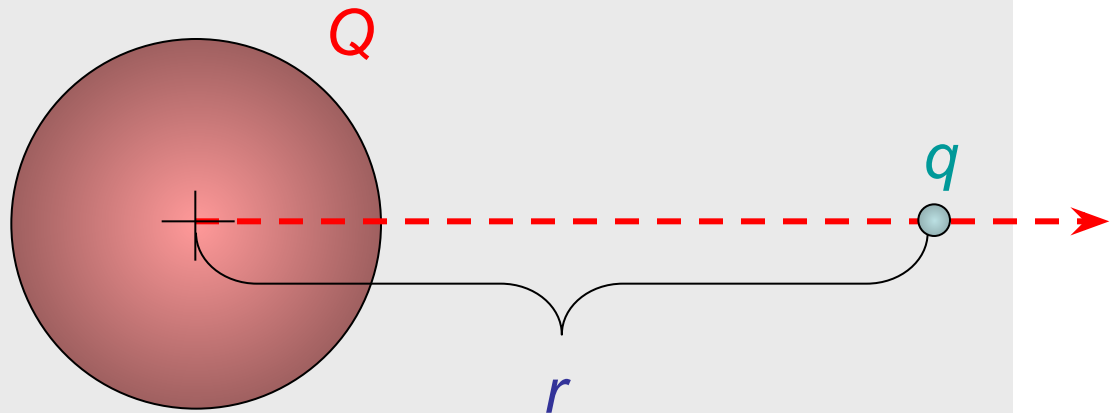


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D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Coulomb's law – extended distribution

- We can use integral calculus to prove that a **spherically symmetric shell of charge Q** acts as if all of its charge is located at its center.
- Thus Coulomb's law works not only for point charges, which have no radii, but for any spherical distribution of charge at any radius.



- Be very clear that r is the **distance between the centers** of the charges.

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Coulomb's law – extended distribution

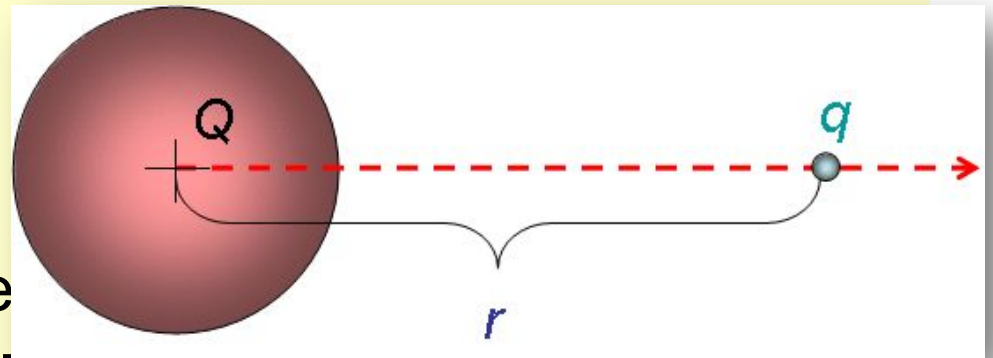
EXAMPLE: A conducting sphere of radius 0.10 m holds an electric charge of $Q = +125 \text{ } \mu\text{C}$. A charge $q = -5.0 \text{ } \mu\text{C}$ is located 0.30 m from the surface of Q . Find the electric force between the two charges.

SOLUTION:

• Use $F = kQq / r^2$, where r is the distance **between the centers** of the charges.

• Then $r = 0.10 + 0.30 = 0.40 \text{ m}$. Thus

$$\begin{aligned} F &= kQq / r^2 \\ &= 8.99 \times 10^9 \times 125 \times 10^{-6} \times -5.0 \times 10^{-6} / 0.40^2 \\ &= -35 \text{ N.} \end{aligned}$$



Topic 5: Electricity and magnetism

5.1 – Electric fields

Electric field - definition

- Suppose a charge q is located a distance r from a another charge Q .
- We define the **electric field strength** E as the force per unit charge acting on q due to the presence of Q .

$$E = F / q$$

electric field strength

- The units are Newtons per Coulomb (N C^{-1}).

PRACTICE: Find the electric field strength 1.0 cm from an electron.

SOLUTION: We have already found the Coulomb force between two electrons located 1.0 cm apart. We just divide our previous answer by one of the charges:

- Then $E = F / q = 2.3 \times 10^{-24} / 1.6 \times 10^{-19} = 1.4 \times 10^{-5} \text{ N C}^{-1}$.

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D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Electric field – definition

EXAMPLE: Let q be a small charge located a distance r from a larger charge Q . Find the electric field strength due to Q at a distance r from the center of Q .

SOLUTION: Use $E = F / q$ and $F = kQq / r^2$.

- From $E = F / q$ we have $Eq = F$.
- And from Coulomb's law we can write

$$Eq = F = kQq / r^2$$

$$Eq = \cancel{k}Qq / \cancel{r^2}$$

- Thus the electric field strength is given by

$$E = kQ / r^2$$

electric field strength at a distance
 r from the center of a charge Q

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D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Electric field – the field model

- In 1905 Albert Einstein published his **Special Theory of Relativity**, which placed an upper bound on the speed anything in the universe could reach.
- According to relativity, nothing can travel faster than the speed of light $c = 3.00 \times 10^8 \text{ ms}^{-1}$.
- Thus the “Coulomb force signal” cannot propagate faster than the speed of light.
- Since the electric force was thought to be an **action-at-a-distance** force, a significant problem arose with the advent of relativity which required a paradigm shift from action-at-a-distance to the new idea of **field**.

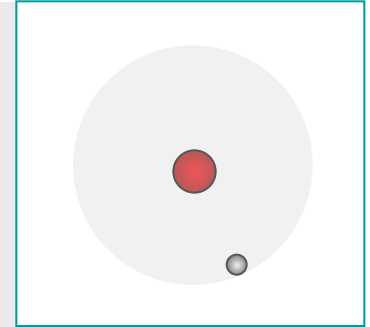


Topic D: Fields

D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Electric field – the field model

- In the action-at-a-distance model, if the Coulomb force signal cannot propagate faster than the speed of light, electrons trapped in orbits about nuclei cannot instantaneously feel the Coulomb force, and thus cannot instantaneously adjust their motion on time to remain in a circular orbit.
- Since electrons in orbit around nuclei do not spiral away, a new model called the **field model** was developed which theorized that *the space surrounding a nucleus is distorted by its charge in such a way that the electron “knows” how to act.*

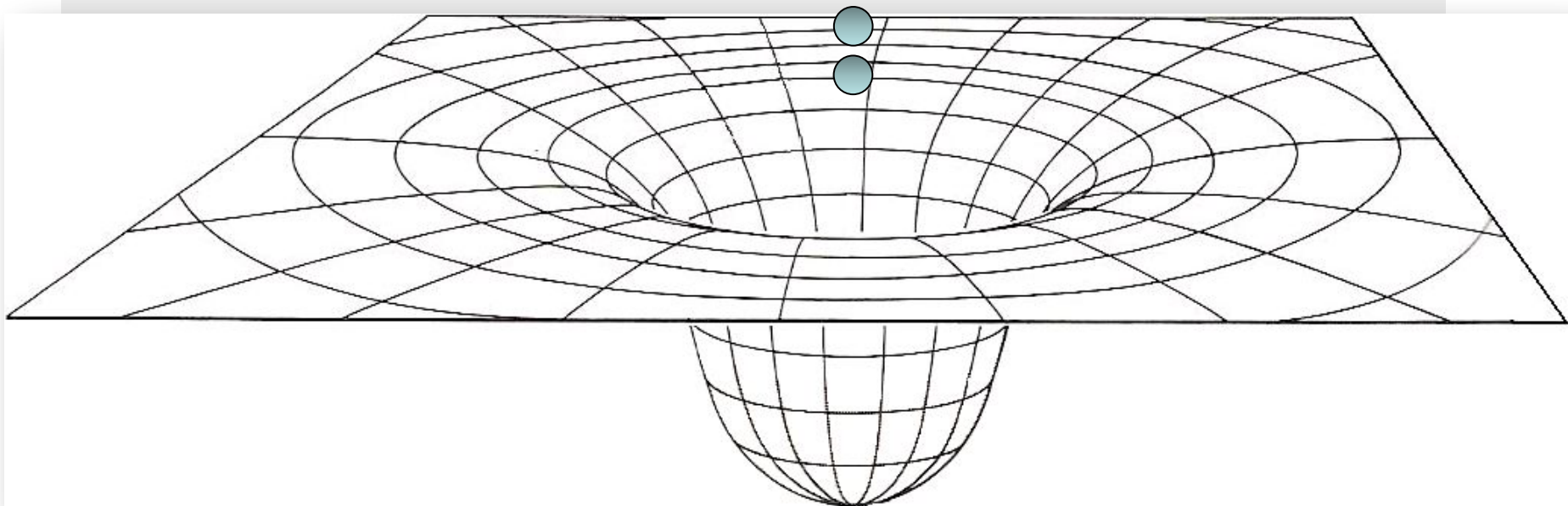


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D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Electric field – the field model

- In the field model the charge Q distorts its surrounding space.
- Then the electrons know which way to curve in their orbits, not by knowing where Q is, but **by knowing the local curvature of their immediate environment.**



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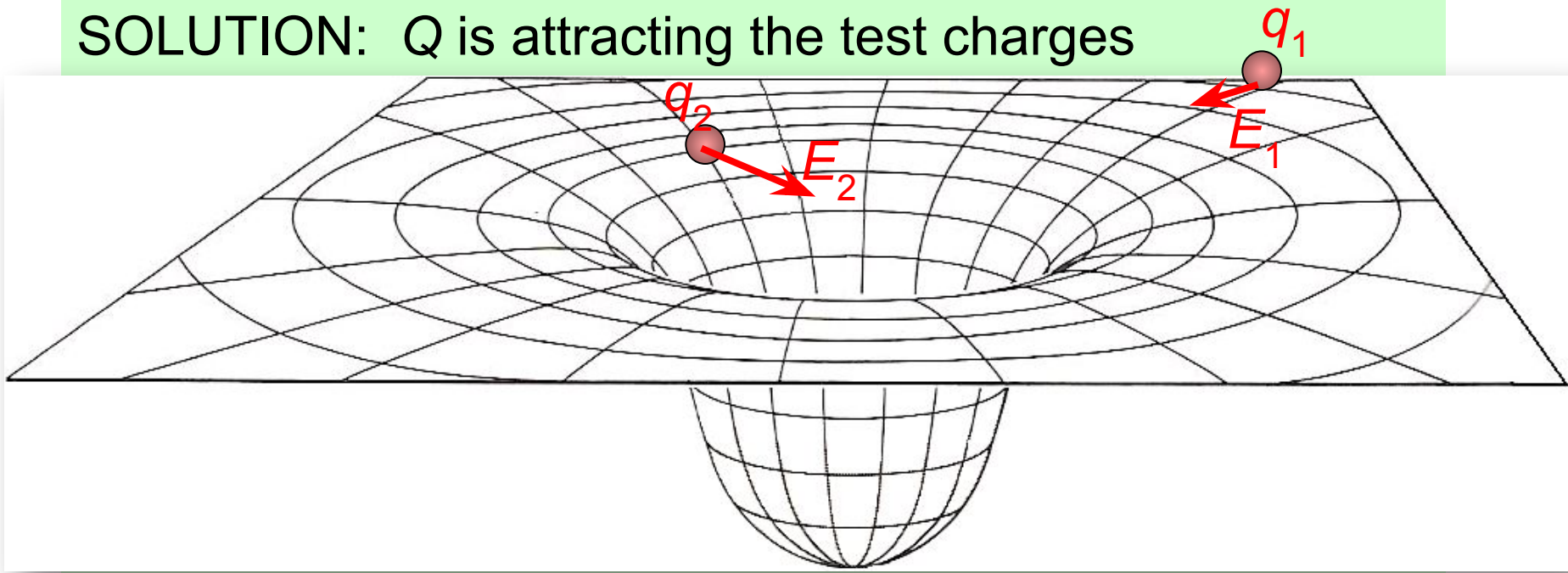
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Electric field – test charges

·In order to explore the electric field in the surrounding a charge we use tiny **POSITIVE test charges**.

PRACTICE: Observe the test charges as they are released. What is the sign of Q ?

SOLUTION: Q is attracting the test charges



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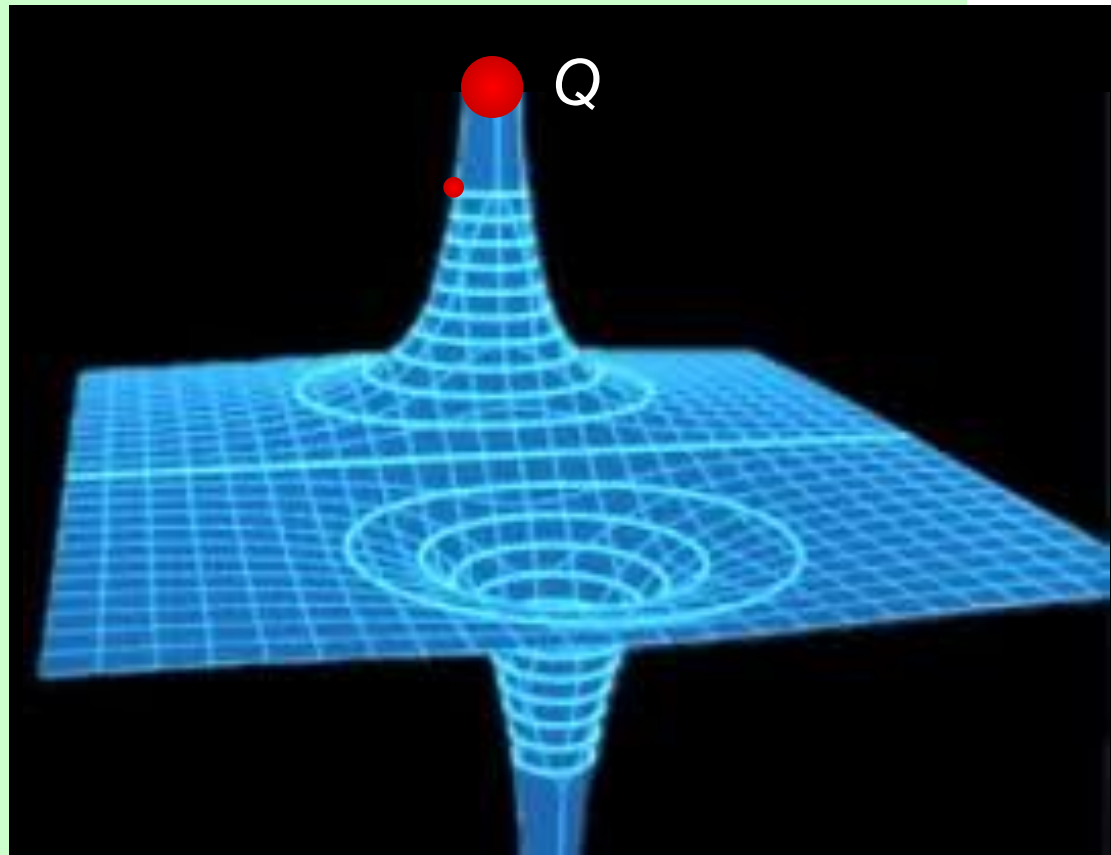
D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Electric field – test charges

PRACTICE: Observe the test charge as it is released.
What is the sign of Q ?

SOLUTION:

· Q is repelling the test charge and since test charges are by definition (+), Q must also be (+).

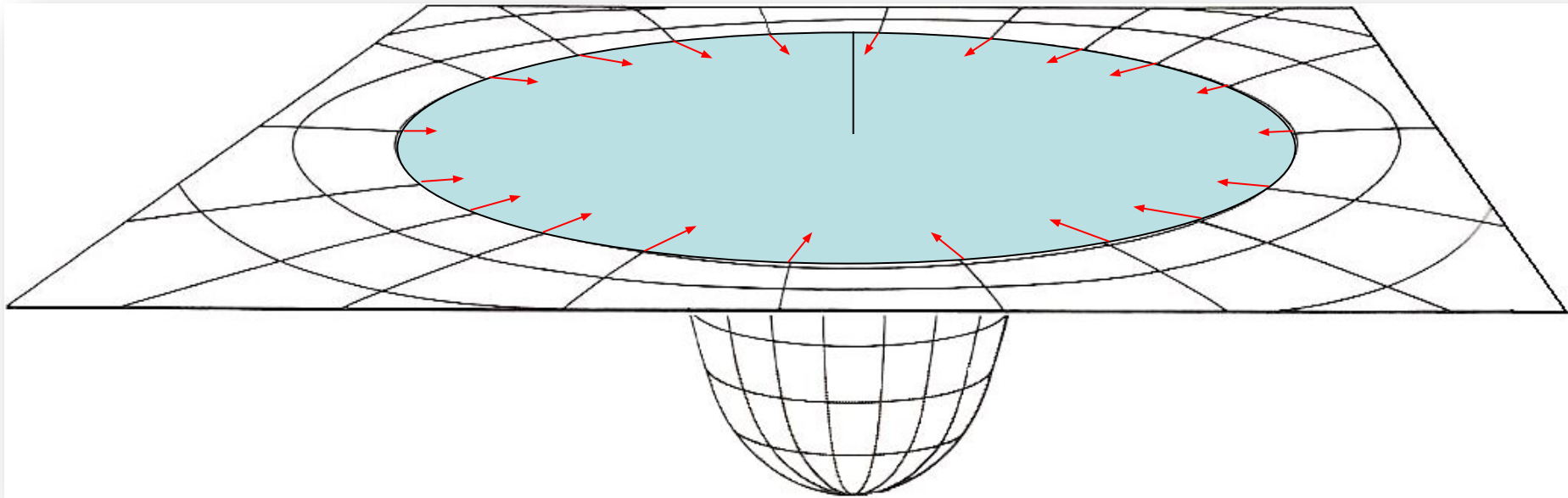


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D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Electric field – test charges

- By “placing” a series of test charges about a negative charge, we can map out its electric field:



- The field arrows of the inner ring are longer than the field arrows of the outer ring and all field arrows point to the centerline.

Topic D: Fields

D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Electric field – sketching

PRACTICE: We can simplify our drawings of electric fields by using top views and using rays. Which field is that of the...

(a) Largest negative charge? **D**

(b) Largest positive charge? **A**

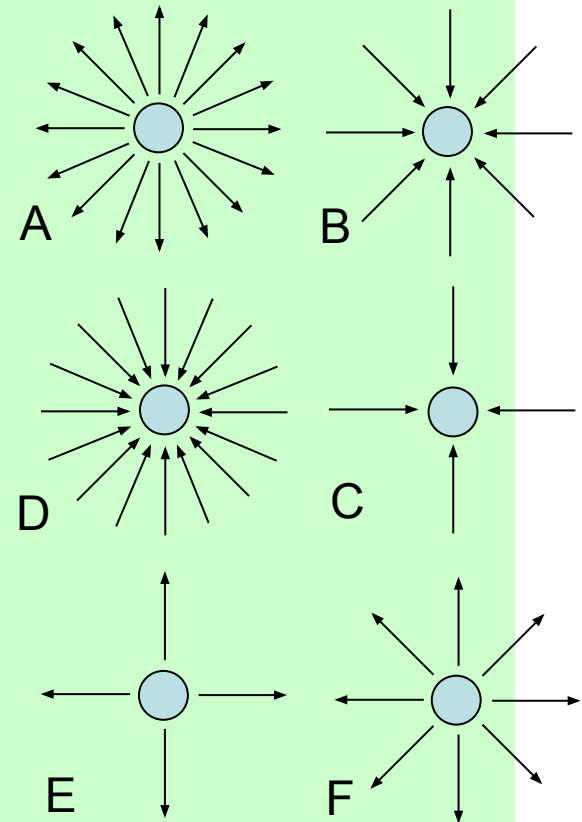
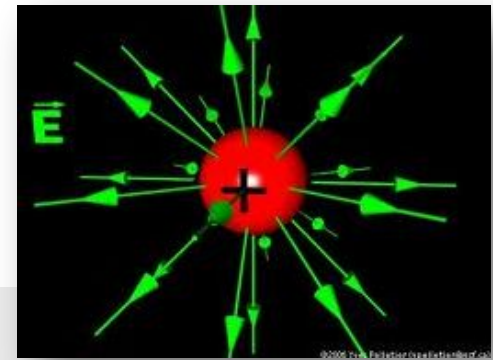
(c) Smallest negative charge? **C**

(d) Smallest positive charge? **E**

SOLUTION: The larger the charge, the more concentrated the field.

• Lines show the direction a positive test charge will go.

• Outward is (+) charge, inward (-).



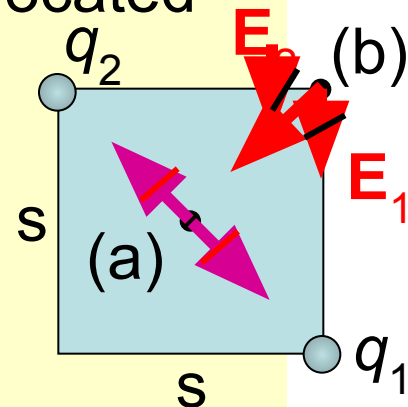
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D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Solving problems involving electric fields

EXAMPLE: Two charges of -0.225 C each are located at opposite corners of a square having a side length of 645 m . Find the electric field vector at

- (a) the center of the square, and
- (b) one of the unoccupied corners.



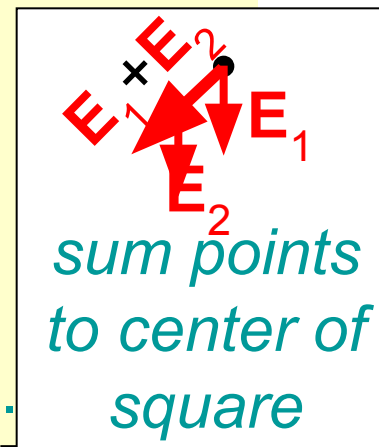
SOLUTION: Start by making a sketch.

- (a) The opposing fields cancel so $E = 0$.
- (b) The two fields are at right angles.

$$E_1 = (8.99 \times 10^9)(-0.225) / 645^2 = -4860 \text{ NC}^{-1} (\downarrow).$$

$$E_2 = (8.99 \times 10^9)(-0.225) / 645^2 = -4860 \text{ NC}^{-1} (\leftarrow).$$

$$E^2 = E_1^2 + E_2^2 = 2(4860)^2 = 47239200 \rightarrow E = 6870 \text{ NC}^{-1}.$$



*sum points
to center of
square*

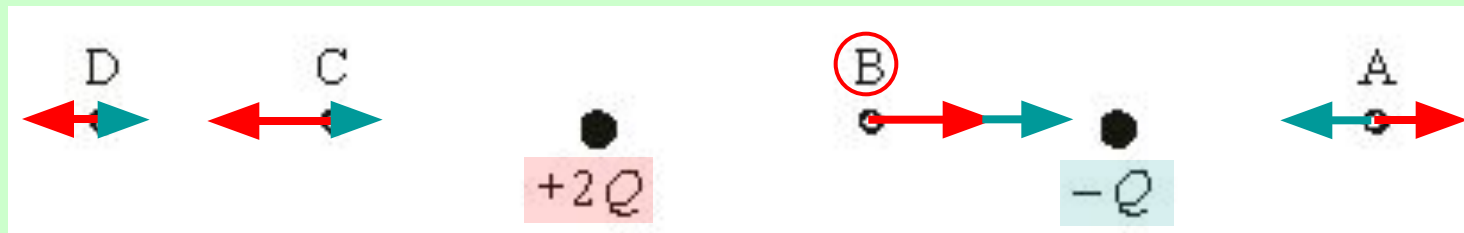
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D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Solving problems involving electric fields

PRACTICE:

Two stationary charges are shown. At which point is the electric field strength the greatest?



SOLUTION:

- Sketch in the field due to each charge at each point.
- Fields diminish as $1 / r^2$.
- Fields point away from (+) and toward (-).
- The only place the fields add is point B.

Topic D: Fields

D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Solving problems involving electric fields

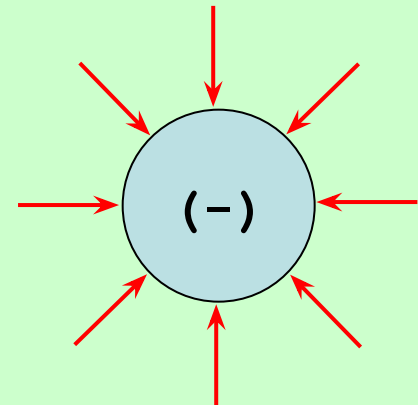
PRACTICE: An isolated metal sphere of radius 1.5 cm has a charge of -15 nC placed on it.

- (a) Sketch in the electric field lines outside the sphere.
- (b) Find the electric field strength at the surface of the sphere.

SOLUTION:

- (a) Field lines point towards (-) charge.
- (b) The field equation works as if all of the charge is at the center of the spherical distribution.

$$E = kQ / r^2$$
$$= (8.99 \times 10^9)(15 \times 10^{-9}) / 0.015^2 = 6.0 \times 10^5 \text{ NC}^{-1}.$$



Topic D: Fields

D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Solving problems involving electric fields

PRACTICE: An isolated metal sphere of radius 1.5 cm has a charge of -15 nC placed on it.

(c) An electron is placed on the outside surface of the sphere and released. What is its initial acceleration?

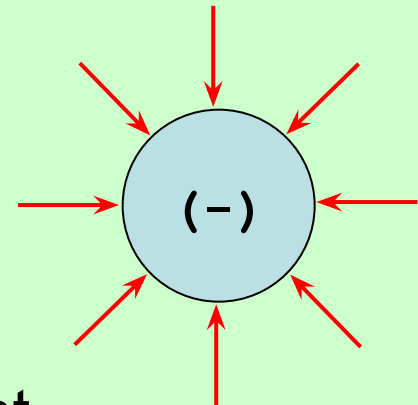
SOLUTION:

(c) The electron feels force $F = Eq$ so that

$$F = Ee = (6.0 \times 10^5)(1.6 \times 10^{-19}) = 9.6 \times 10^{-14} \text{ N.}$$

But $F = ma$ so that

$$\begin{aligned} a &= F / m \\ &= (9.6 \times 10^{-14}) / (9.11 \times 10^{-31}) = 1.1 \times 10^{17} \text{ m s}^{-2}. \end{aligned}$$

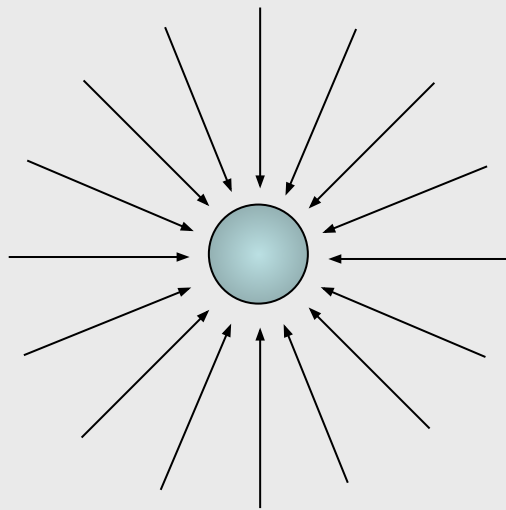


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D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

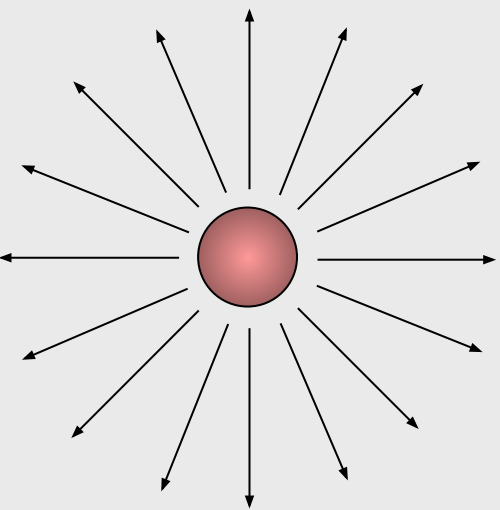
Electric monopoles and dipoles

- Because there are two types of electric charge, electric fields can have field lines pointing inward AND outward.
- A single charge is called a **monopole**.



Negative sphere
of charge

MONOPOLES



Positive sphere of
charge

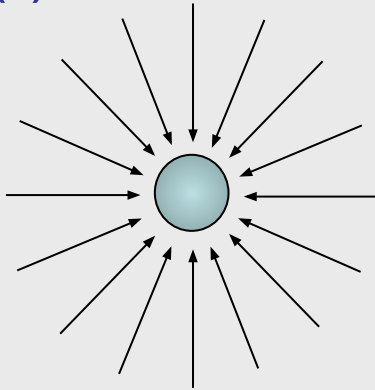
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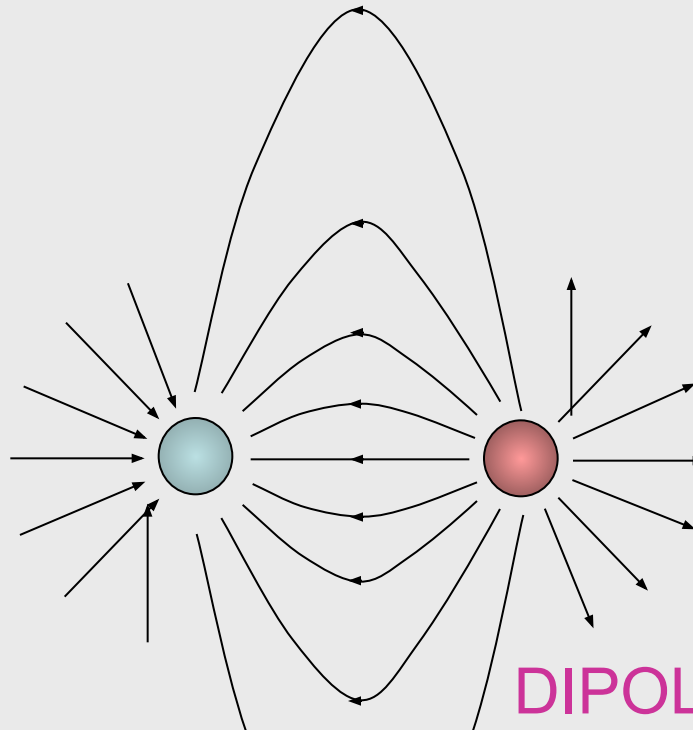
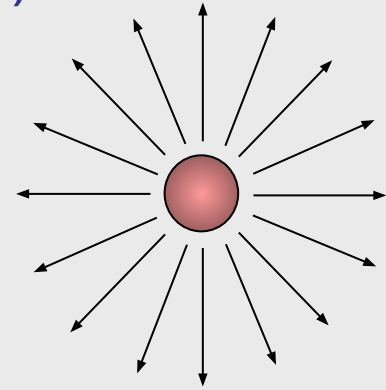
Electric monopoles and dipoles

·If two opposite electric monopoles are near enough to each other their field lines interact as shown here:

(-) MONOPOLE



(+) MONOPOLE



Topic D: Fields

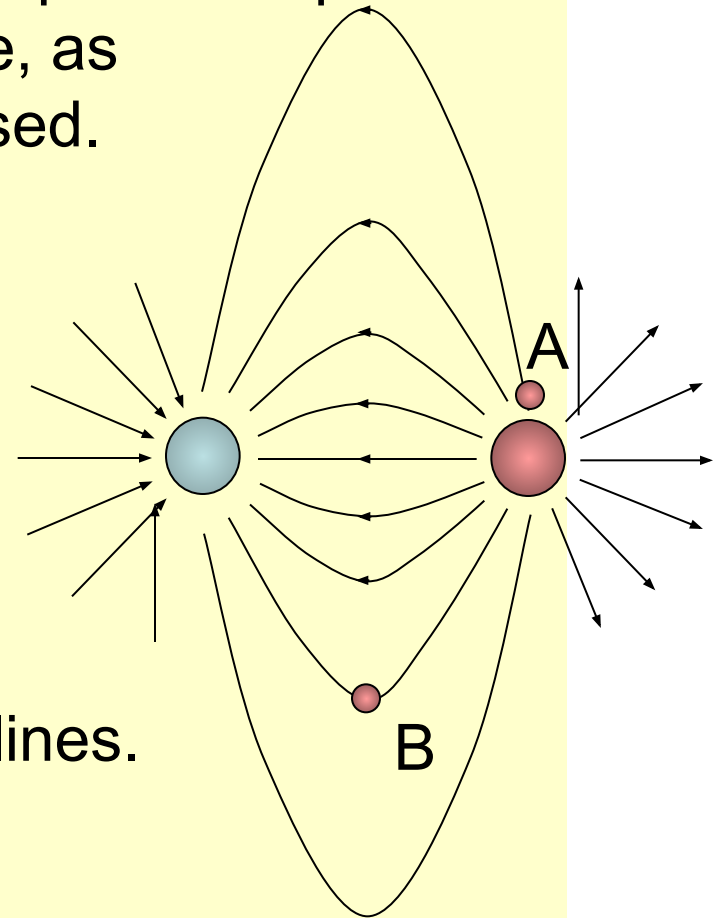
D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Solving problems involving electric fields

EXAMPLE: Suppose test charges are placed at points A and B in the electric field of the dipole, as shown. Trace their paths when released.

SOLUTION:

· Just remember: Test charges travel with the field arrows and on the field lines.



Topic D: Fields

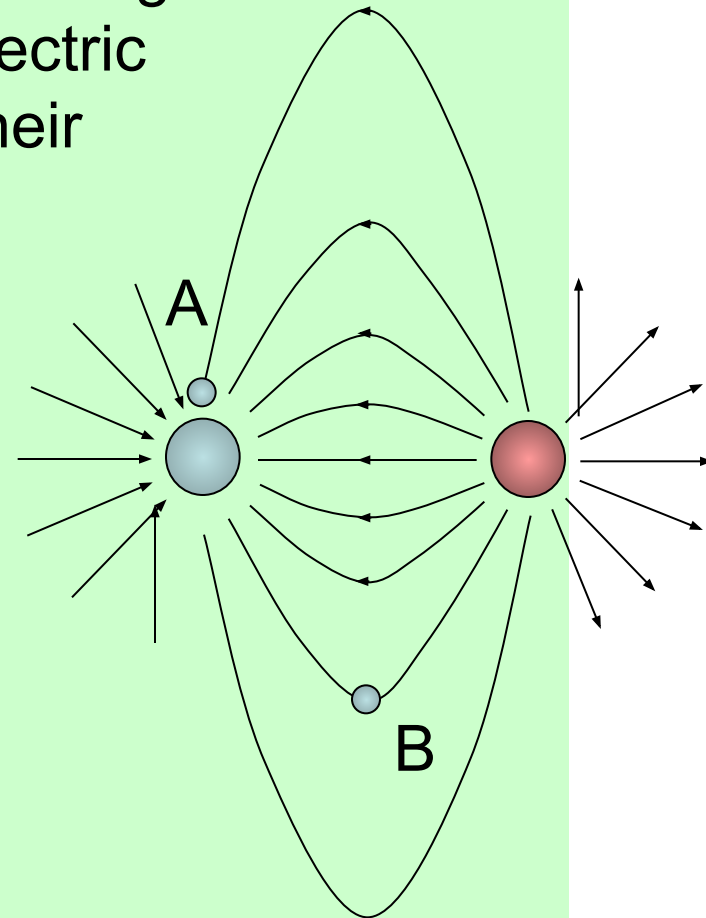
D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Solving problems involving electric fields

PRACTICE: Suppose small negative charges are placed at points A and B in the electric field of the dipole, as shown. Trace their paths when released.

SOLUTION:

· Just remember: (-) charges travel against the field arrows and on the field lines.



Topic D: Fields

D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Solving problems involving electric fields

PRACTICE: If the charge on a 25 cm radius metal sphere is $+150\ \mu\text{C}$, calculate

- (a) the electric field strength at the surface.
- (b) the field strength 25 cm from the surface.
- (c) the force on a $-0.75\ \mu\text{C}$ charge placed 25 cm from the surface.

SOLUTION: Use $E = kQ / r^2$, and for (c) use $E = F / q$.

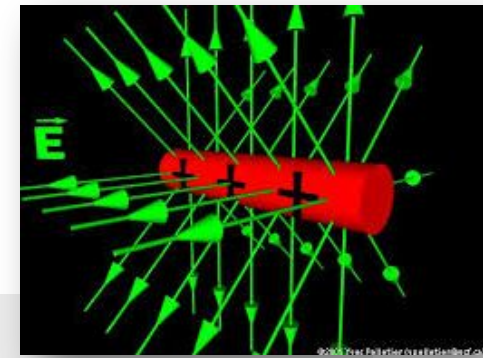
$$\begin{aligned}\text{(a)} \quad E &= kQ / r^2 \\ &= (8.99 \times 10^9)(150 \times 10^{-6}) / 0.25^2 = 2.2 \times 10^7 \text{ NC}^{-1}.\end{aligned}$$

$$\text{(b)} \quad E = (8.99 \times 10^9)(150 \times 10^{-6}) / 0.50^2 = 5.4 \times 10^6 \text{ NC}^{-1}.$$

$$\text{(c)} \quad F = Eq = (5.4 \times 10^6)(-0.75 \times 10^{-6}) = -4.0 \text{ N}.$$

Topic D: Fields

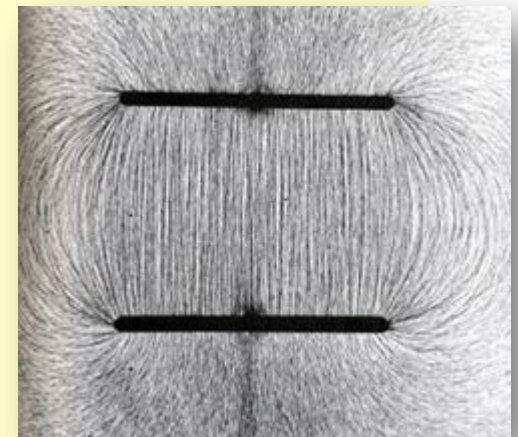
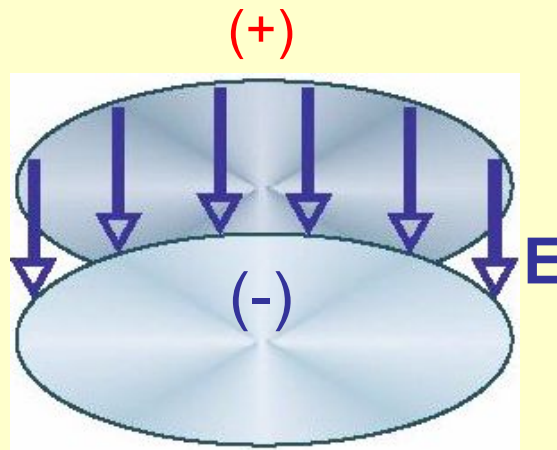
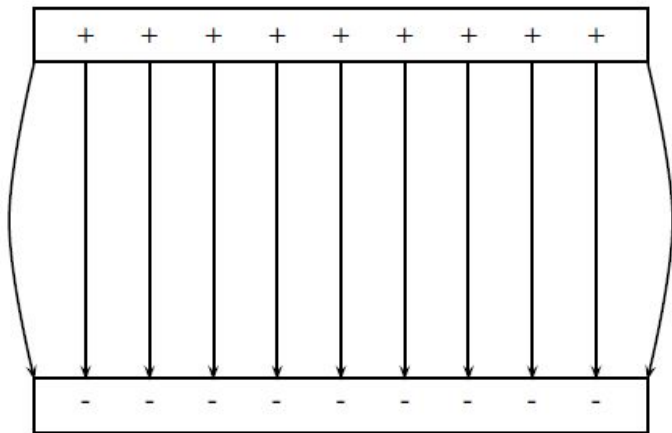
D.2 – Electric fields (SL)



Electric field – between parallel plates

EXAMPLE: If we take two parallel plates of metal and give them equal and opposite charge, what does the electric field look like between the plates?

SOLUTION: Just remember: Field lines point away from (+) charge and toward (-) charge.



Topic D: Fields

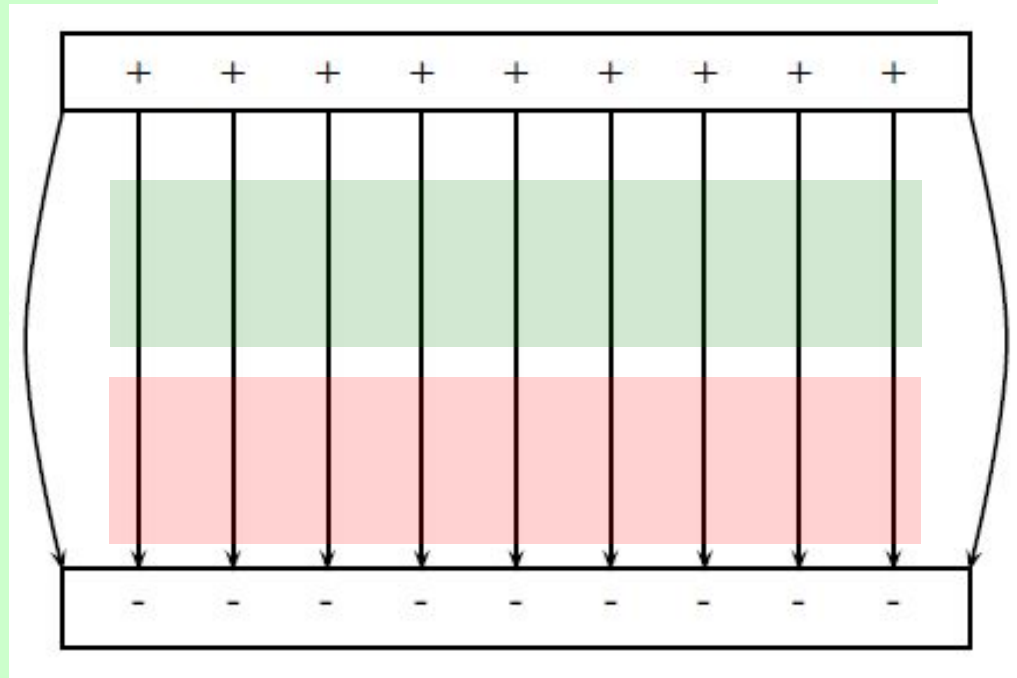
D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Electric field – between parallel plates

PRACTICE: Justify the statement “the electric field strength is uniform between two parallel plates.”

SOLUTION:

- Sketch the electric field lines between two parallel plates.
- Now demonstrate that the electric field lines have equal density everywhere between the plates.

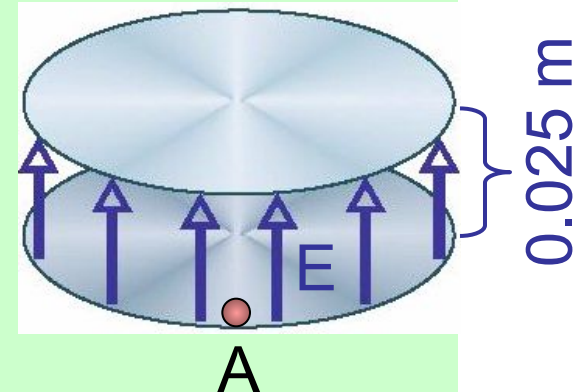


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D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Electric field – between parallel plates

PRACTICE: The uniform electric field strength inside the parallel plates is 275 N C^{-1} . A $+12 \text{ } \mu\text{C}$ charge having a mass of 0.25 grams is placed in the field at A and released.



- (a) What is the electric force acting on the charge?
- (b) What is the weight of the charge?

SOLUTION:

(a) $F = Eq = (275)(12 \times 10^{-6}) = 0.0033 \text{ N}.$

(b) Change grams to kg by jumping 3 places left:

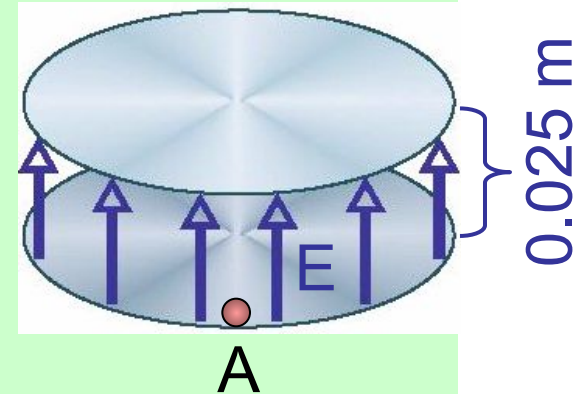
$$F = mg = (0.00025)(9.8) = 0.0025 \text{ N}.$$

Topic D: Fields

D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Electric field – between parallel plates

PRACTICE: The uniform electric field strength inside the parallel plates is 275 N C^{-1} . A $+12 \text{ } \mu\text{C}$ charge having a mass of 0.25 grams is placed in the field at A and released.



(c) What is the acceleration of the charge?

SOLUTION: Use $F_{\text{net}} = ma$.

The electric force is trying to make the charge go up, and the weight is trying to make it go down. Thus

$$F_{\text{net}} = 0.0033 - 0.0025 = 0.0008 \text{ N.}$$

$$F_{\text{net}} = ma$$

$$0.0008 = 0.00025a \rightarrow a = 3.2 \text{ m s}^{-2} (\uparrow).$$

Topic D: Fields

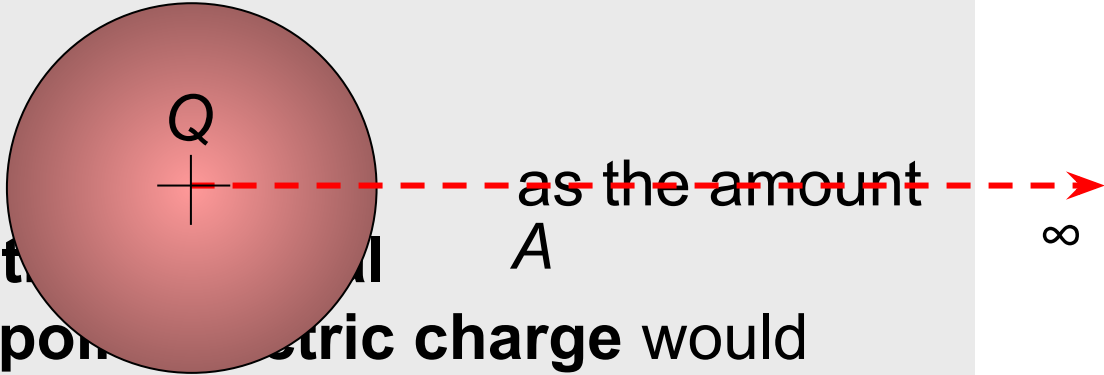
D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Electric Potential

- Because electric charges experience the electric force, when one charge is moved in the vicinity of another, work W is done (recall that work is a force times a displacement).

- We define the

electric potential V as the amount of electric potential energy that a unitary positive electric charge would have if located at any point in space (e.g. at point A)



The diagram shows a red circle representing a positive point charge labeled 'Q'. A horizontal dashed red line extends from the center of the circle to the right, ending in an arrowhead and the symbol for infinity (∞). The letter 'A' is placed on this line, representing a point in space.

energy that a **unitary positive electric charge** would have if located at any point in space (e.g. at point A)

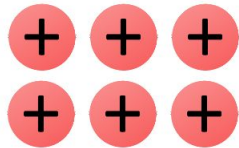
- It is equal to the work done by an **electric** field in carrying a unit positive charge to a location from infinity.

Topic D: Fields

D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Electric Potential

- The **higher the concentration of positive (+)** charge in an area, the **higher the electric potential** is in that area
- Likewise, the **higher the concentration of negative (-)** charge in an area, the **lower the electric potential** is in that area.



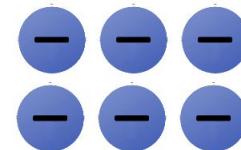
Higher
potential



High
potential



Low
potential



Lower
potential

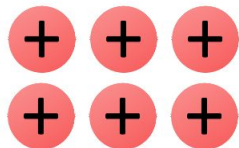
- Note: **Electric potential** is different to the **electric potential energy**!

Topic D: Fields

D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Electric Potential

- Positive (+) charges will naturally move from higher to lower electric potentials.
 - Much like how a “positive” mass moves from a higher to lower gravitational potential
- Note: Negative (-) charges will naturally move from lower to higher electric potentials.
 - There is no analog to this with gravitation because there is no “negative” mass.



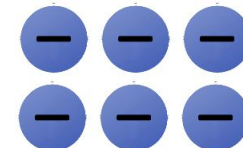
Higher
potential



High
potential



Low
potential



Lower
potential

Topic D: Fields

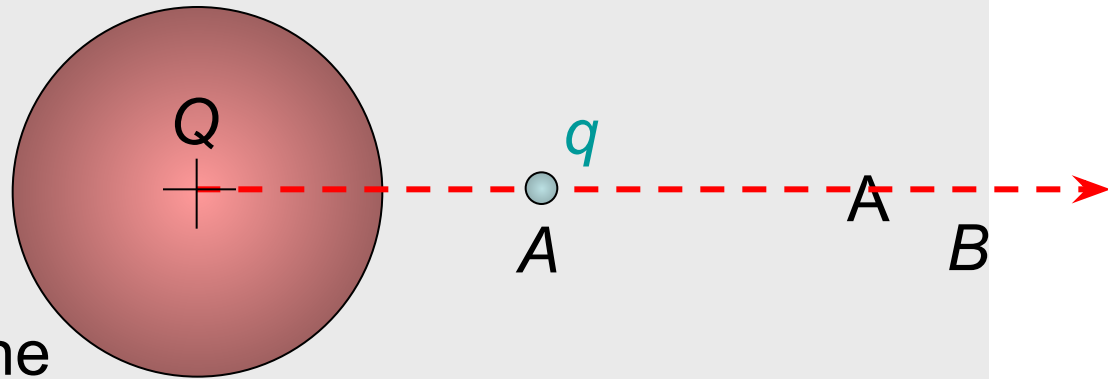
D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Potential difference

·Because electric charges experience the electric force, when one charge is moved in the vicinity of another, work W is done (recall that work is a force times a displacement).

·We define the **potential difference**

V at any point A and B as the amount of work W done per unit charge in moving a point charge from A to B.



$$V = V_B - V_A = W / q$$

potential difference

·Note that the units of V are JC^{-1} which are volts V.

Topic D: Fields

D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Potential difference

PRACTICE: A charge of $q = +15.0 \mu\text{C}$ is moved from point A , having an electric potential of 25.0 V to point B , having a electric potential of 18.0 V .

(a) What is the potential difference undergone by the charge?

(b) What is the work done in moving the charge from A to B ?



SOLUTION:

(a) $V = V_B - V_A = 18.0 - 25.0 = -7.0 \text{ V}.$

(b) $W = qV = 15.0 \times 10^{-6} \times -7.0 = -1.1 \times 10^{-4} \text{ J}.$

FYI

• Many books use ΔV instead of V .

Topic D: Fields

D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Potential difference – the electronvolt

- When speaking of energies of individual charges (like electrons in atoms), rather than large groups of charges (like currents through wire), Joules are too large and awkward.
- We define the **electronvolt** eV as the work done when 1 elementary charge e is moved through a potential difference of 1V. ($1\text{V} = 1 \text{ JC}^{-1}$)
- From $W = qV$ we see that

$$1 \text{ eV} = eV = (1.60 \times 10^{-19} \text{ C})(1 \text{ JC}^{-1}) = 1.60 \times 10^{-19} \text{ J.}$$

$$1 \text{ eV} = 1.60 \times 10^{-19} \text{ J}$$

electronvolt conversion

FYI ·We will use electronvolts in Topic 7 when we study atomic physics.

Topic D: Fields

D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Potential difference – the electronvolt

PRACTICE: An electron is moved from Point A, having a voltage (potential) of 25.0 V, to Point B, having a voltage (potential) of 18.0 V.



(a) What is the work done (in eV and in J) on the electron by the external force during the displacement?

SOLUTION:

• Use $W = q(V_B - V_A)$. Then

$$W = -e(18.0 \text{ V} - 25.0 \text{ V}) = 7.0 \text{ eV.}$$

$$7.0 \text{ eV} (1.60 \times 10^{-19} \text{ J / eV}) = 1.12 \times 10^{-18} \text{ J.}$$

FYI

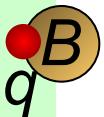
• Since the electron is more attracted to A than B, we have stored this energy as potential energy.

Topic D: Fields

D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Potential difference – the electronvolt

PRACTICE: An electron is moved from Point A, having a voltage (potential) of 25.0 V, to Point B, having a voltage (potential) of 18.0 V.



(b) If the electron is released from Point B, what is its speed when it reaches Point A?

SOLUTION: Use $\Delta E_K + \Delta E_P = 0$ with $\Delta E_P = -1.12 \times 10^{-18}$.

$$\Delta E_K = -\Delta E_P$$

$$(1/2)mv^2 - (1/2)mu^2 = -(-1.12 \times 10^{-18})$$

$$(1/2)mv^2 - (1/2)m0^2 = 1.12 \times 10^{-18}$$

$$(1/2)(9.11 \times 10^{-31})v^2 = 1.12 \times 10^{-18}$$

$$v^2 = 2.45 \times 10^{12}$$

$$v = 1.57 \times 10^6 \text{ ms}^{-1}.$$

Topic D: Fields

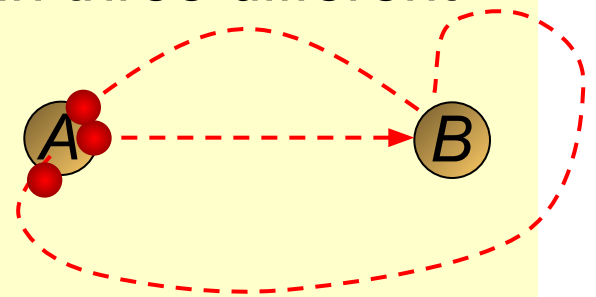
D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Potential difference – path independence

EXAMPLE: A charge of $q = +15.0 \mu\text{C}$ is moved from point A, having a voltage (potential) of 25.0 V to point B, having a voltage (potential) of 18.0 V, in three different ways. What is the work done in each case?

SOLUTION:

- The work is independent of the path because the electric force is a **conservative force**.
- $W = qV = 15.0 \times 10^{-6} \times -7.0 = -1.1 \times 10^{-4} \text{ J}$. Same for all.



FYI

- We found out in Topic D.1 that gravity is also a conservative force.

Topic D: Fields

D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Potential difference – between parallel plates

PRACTICE: Two parallel plates with plate separation d are charged up to a potential difference of V simply by connecting a battery (shown) to them.

The electric field between the plates is E .

A positive charge q is moved from A to B.

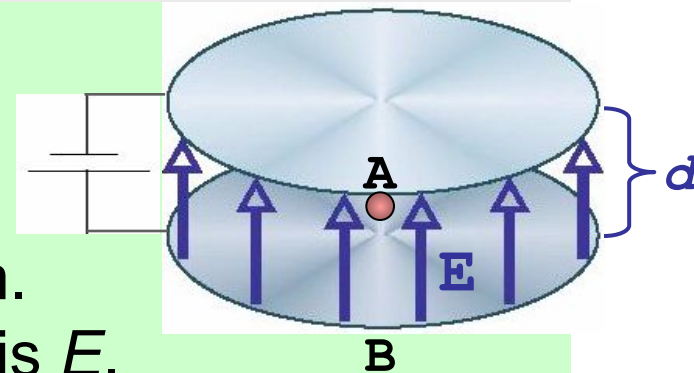
(a) How much work is done in moving q through the distance d ?

(b) Find the potential difference V across the plates.

SOLUTION: Use $W = Fd \cos \theta$, $F = Eq$, and $W = qV$.

(a) $W = Fd \cos 0^\circ = (Eq)d$.

(b) $qV = Eqd \rightarrow V = Ed$.



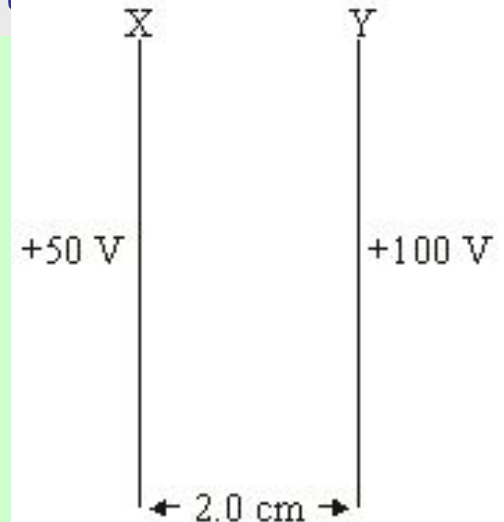
$$E = \frac{V}{d}$$

Topic D: Fields

D.2 – Electric fields (SL)

Potential difference – between parallel plates

PRACTICE: Two parallel plates with plate separation 2.0 cm are charged up to the potential difference shown. Which one of the following shows the correct direction and strength of the resulting electric field?



SOLUTION:

· Since the greater positive is plate Y, the electric field lines point from Y → X.

· From $V = Ed$ we see that

$$E = V / d$$

$$= (100 - 50) / 2$$

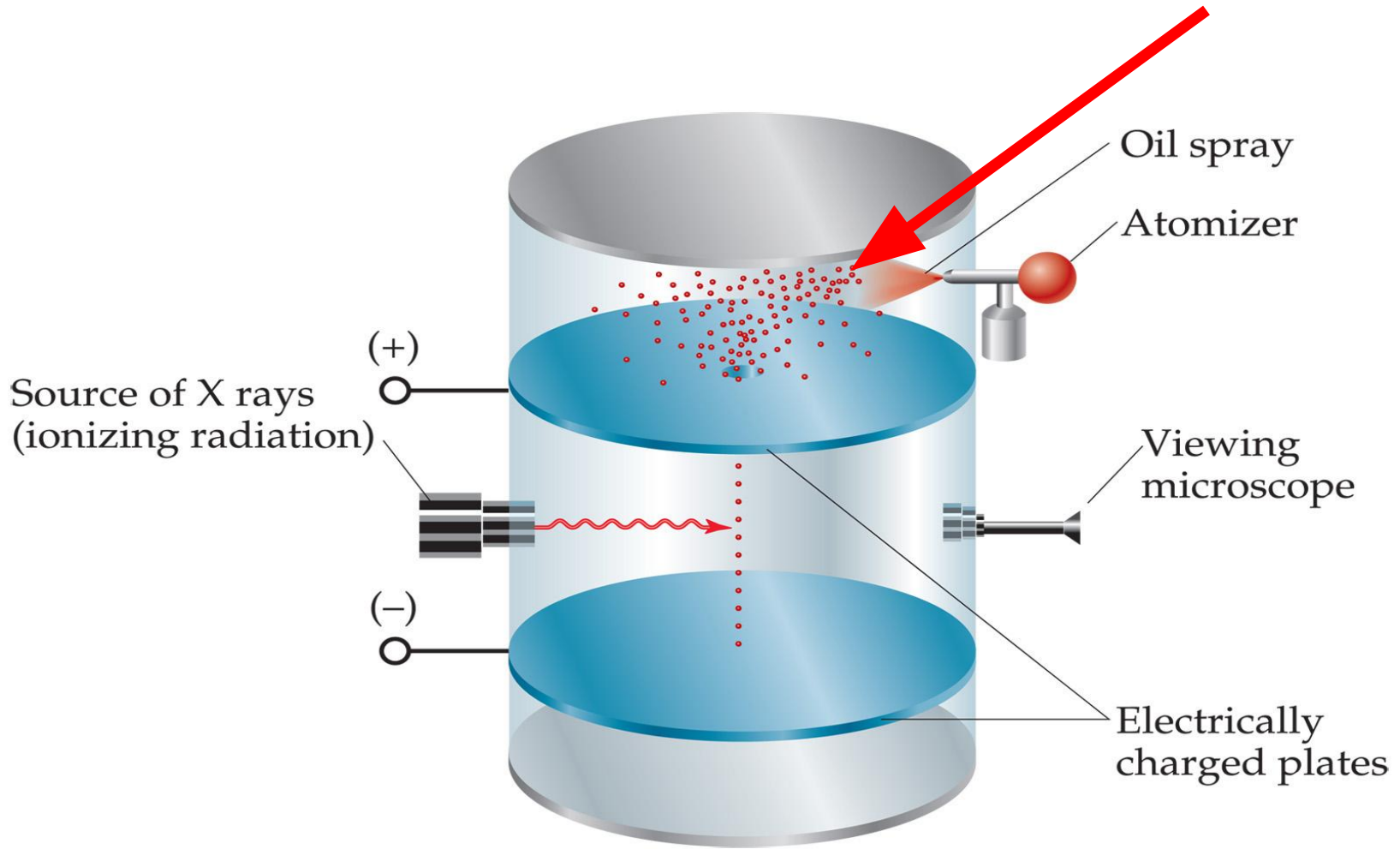
$$= 25 \text{ V cm}^{-1}.$$

	Direction	Strength / V cm^{-1}
A.	X → Y	25
B.	X → Y	100
C.	Y → X	25
D.	Y → X	100

Millikan's Oil Drop Experiment

- I. Charge of electron – very important application of uniform electric field between two plate – Robert Millikan (1868-1953)
 - A. Purpose: to find charge of an electron

1. Fine oil sprayed into air in top – gravity causes them to fall



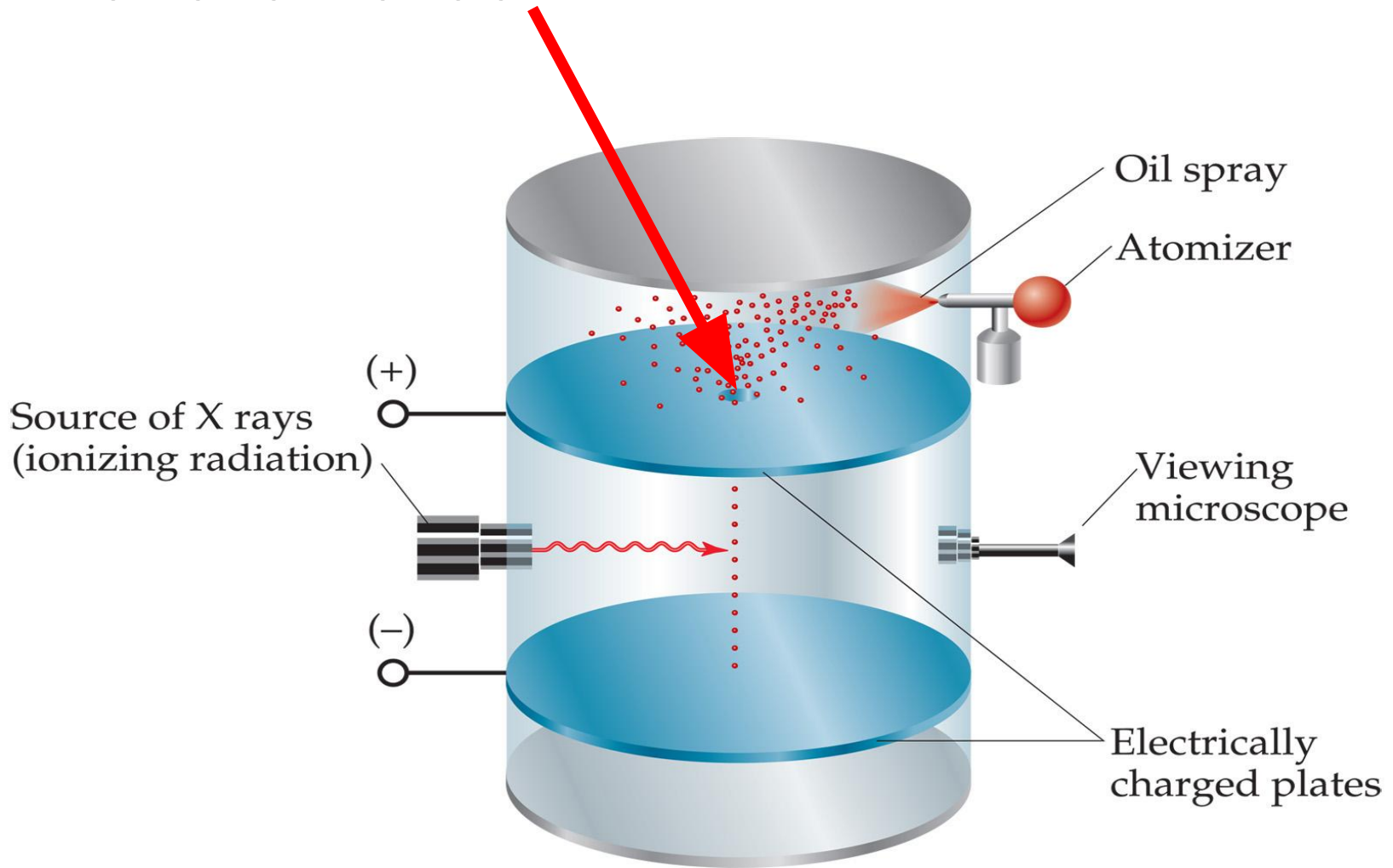
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2. A few enter the hole



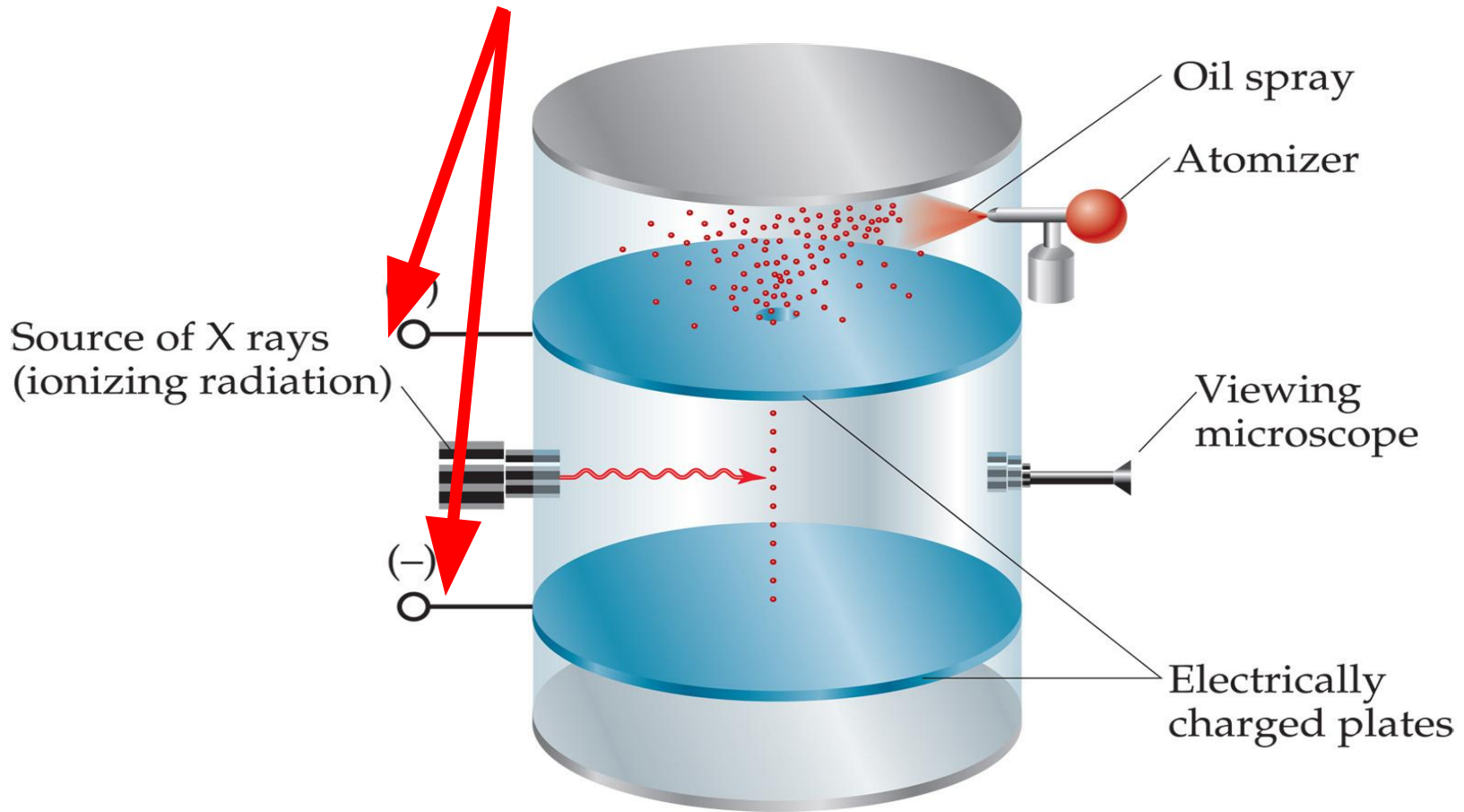
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3. Potential difference between plates is applied – exerts a force on the charged drops



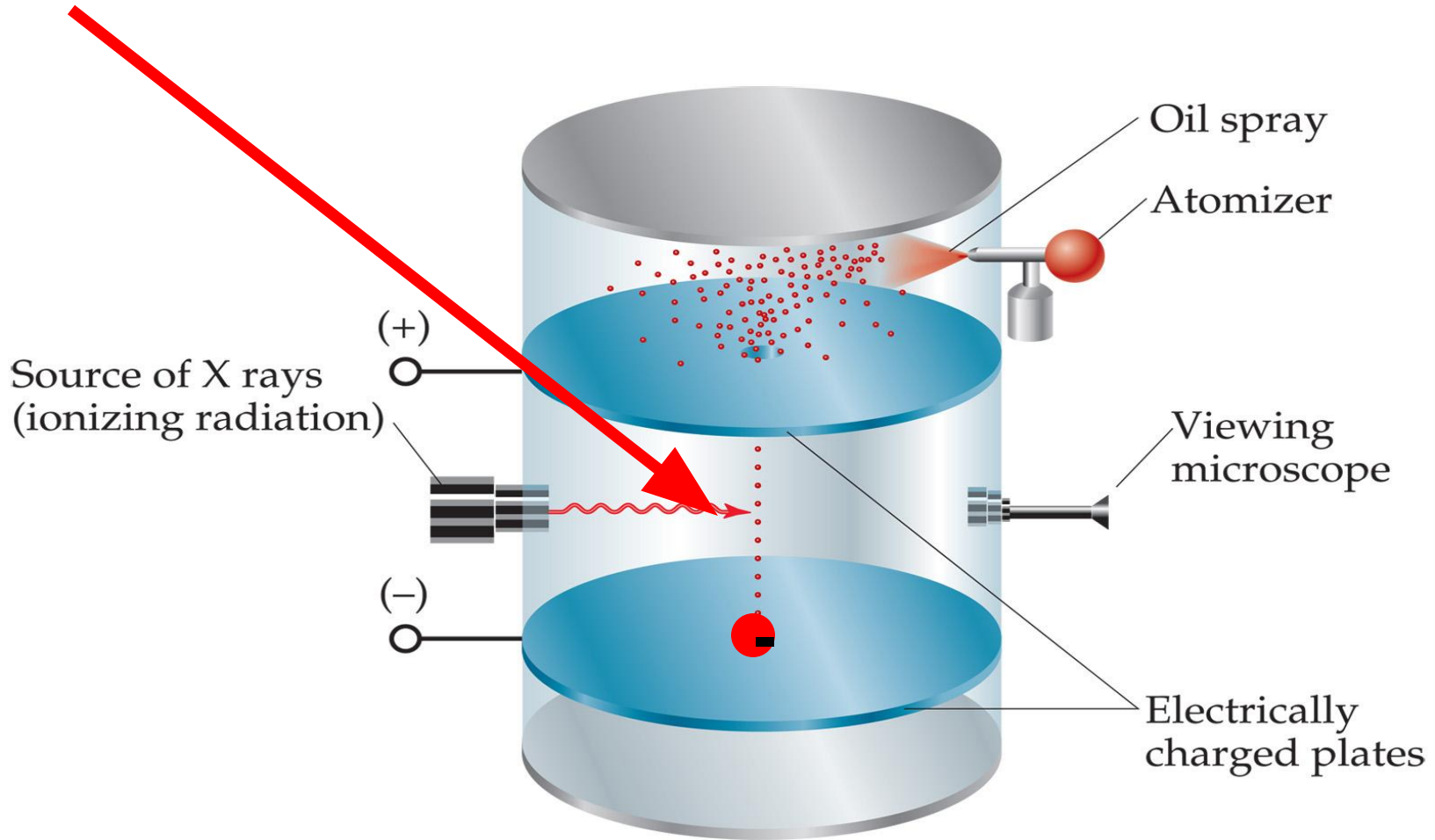
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4. Top plate is positive enough that negative drops will rise



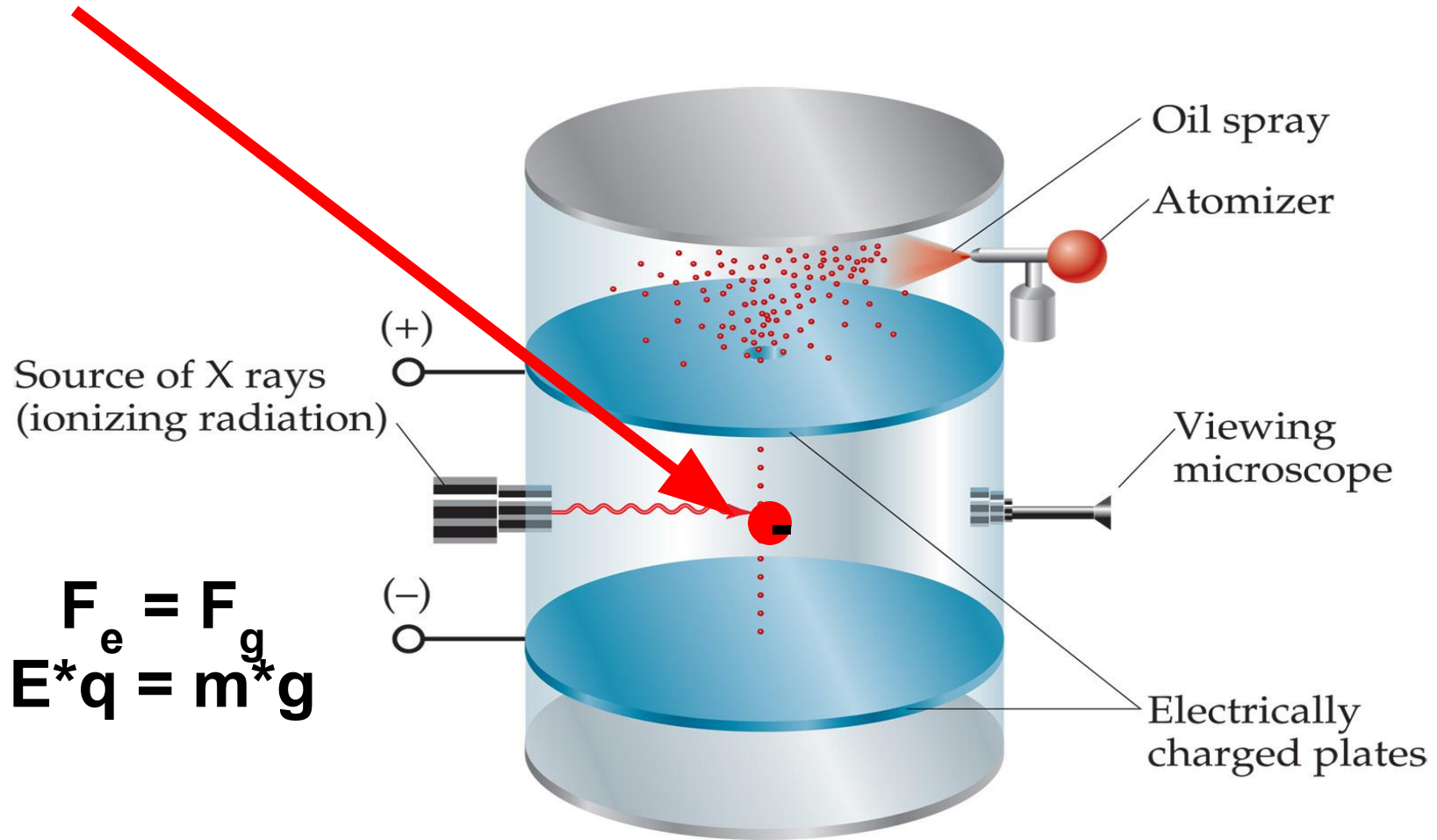
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5. Potential difference adjusted to suspend (float) particle



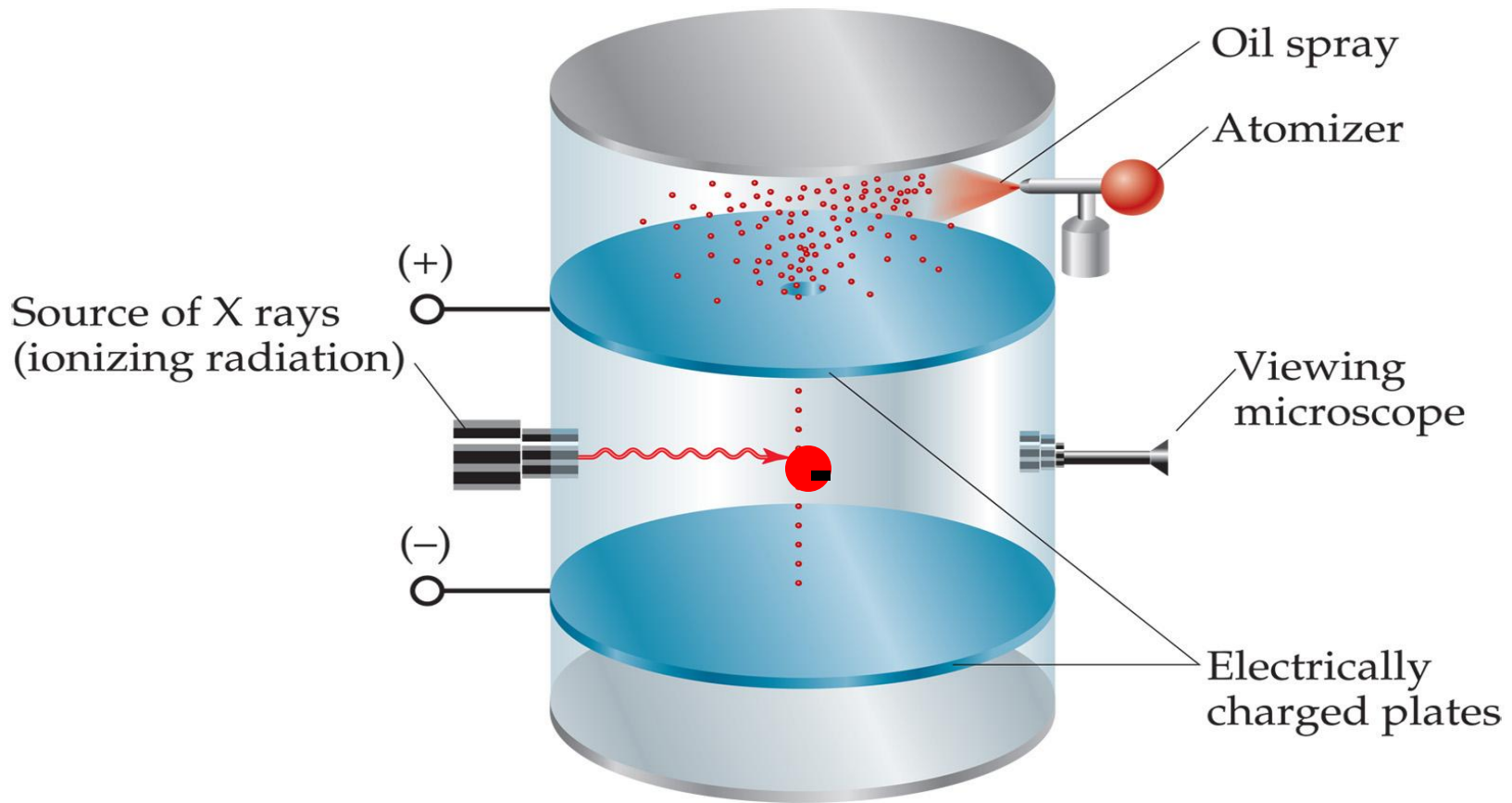
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6. Electric field was determined from potential difference between two plates ($E = V/d$)



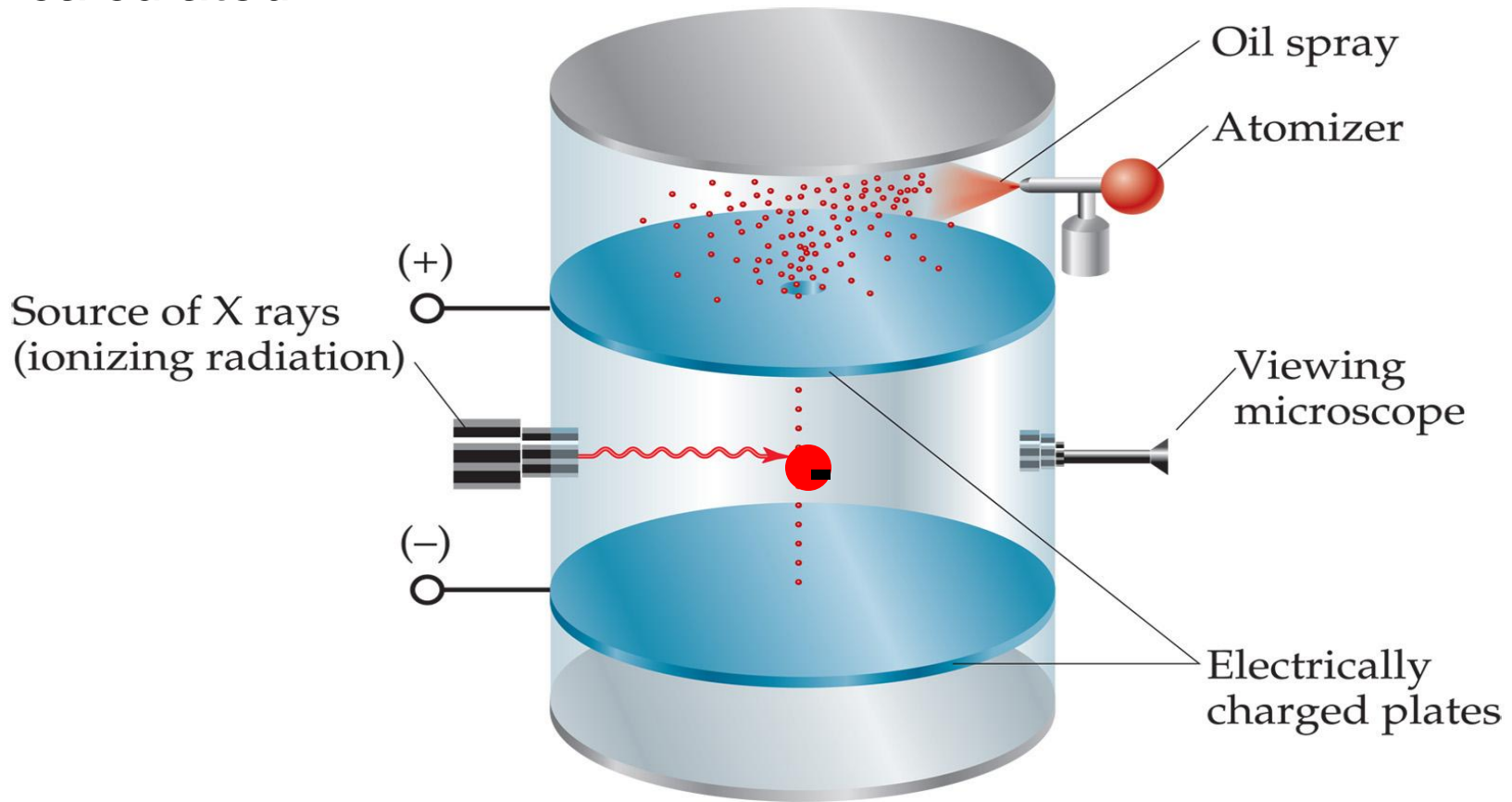
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7. Found velocity of charge when field was turned off. Using velocity, mg was found. Using E & mg , the charge could be calculated.



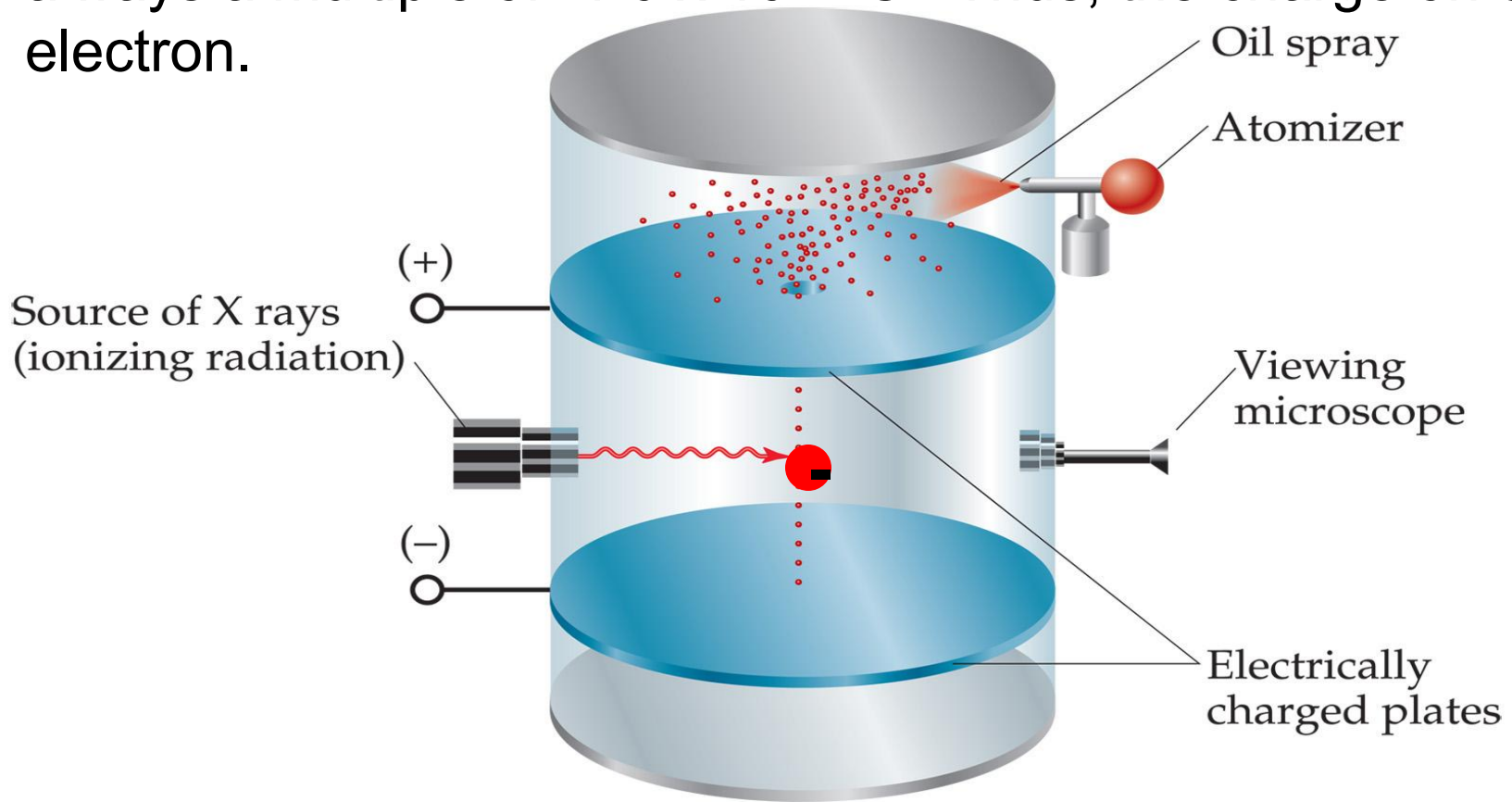
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8. The drops had a variety of charges. So, he ionized the air, added or removed electrons. The change in charge was always a multiple of $-1.6 \times 10^{-19} \text{ C}$. Thus, the charge on one electron.



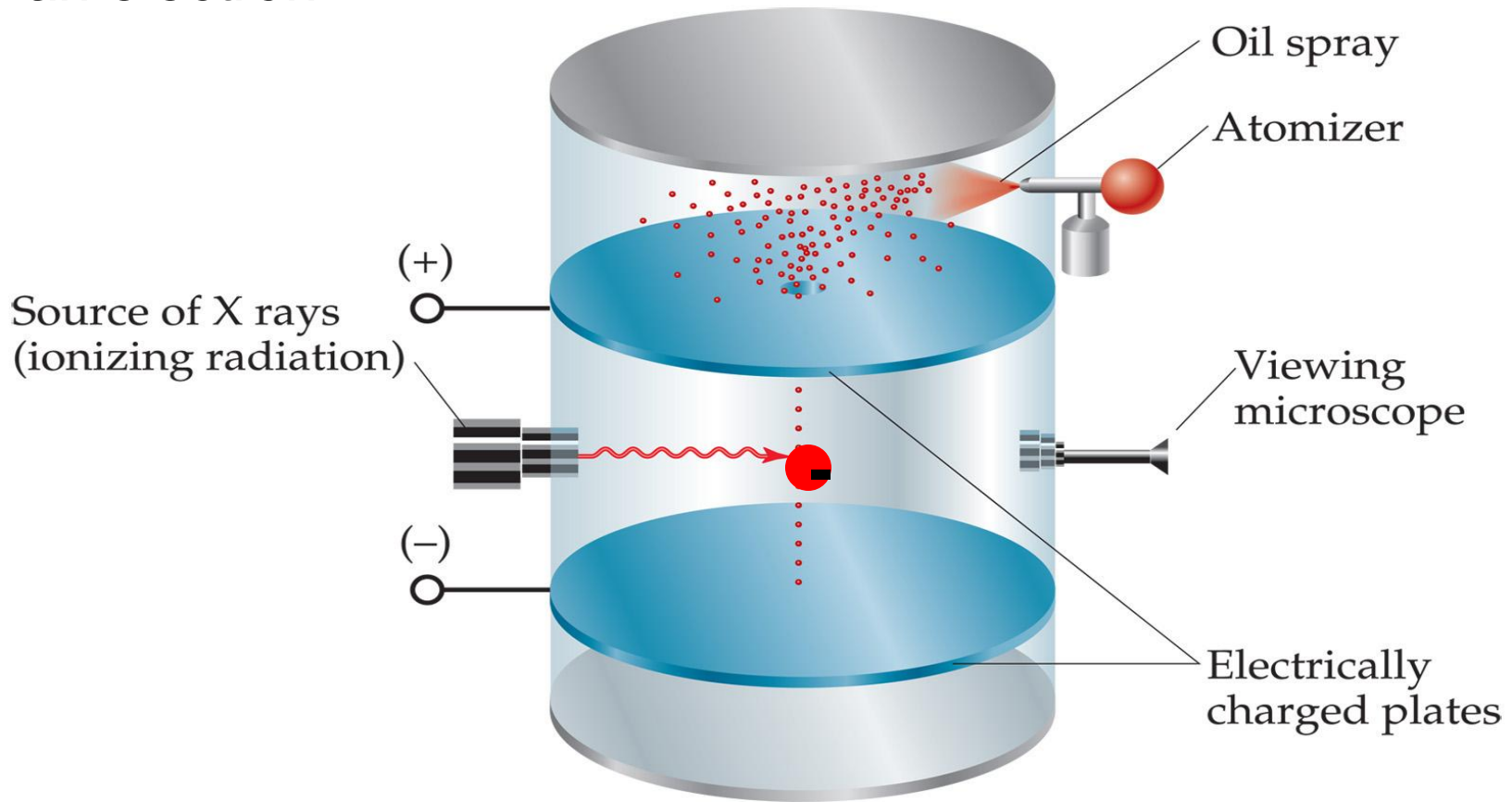
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9. Showed that charge is *quantized* – an object can only have charge with a magnitude that is some integral of the charge of an electron.



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